

Ian Ronk

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Data Lead & Engineer · Independent Researcher

Production data systems and the data engineering behind research: Airflow, DuckDB and PostGIS pipelines that turn open spatial data into papers. Leads a team of 4 as Head of Data; publishes independent research on urban dynamics.

TOOLS

Python · SQL · PostGIS · Airflow · DuckDB · PyTorch · MLflow · Bash · LLM pipelines

EXPERIENCE

Head of Data, KR&A, Amsterdam

Jul 2025 – present

- Lead a team of 4 through a transformation of the product offering, serving pension funds and leading FinTechs.
- Develop, maintain and expand data pipelines (e.g. a weekly scrape of 300k records) and spatial big data products.
- Delivered a global connectivity score: 1TB+ processed across 13 servers into a production API.
- Represent the data function with clients: defending methodology against PhD-level scrutiny, presenting to portfolio managers and senior stakeholders.
- Drive AI adoption: OCR and LLM document extraction, agentic pipeline monitoring, agent-assisted development.

Independent Researcher, urban dynamics

2025 – present

- Self-directed research programme: two working papers and a method paper in preparation (see Research), each backed by an open, reproducible pipeline.

Medior Data Scientist, KR&A

Jun 2022 – Jul 2025

- Project lead for two multi-year projects, including a 3-year hedonic house-price-index project for Eurostat: scraping, storing and managing the data, building the regressions, interpreting results.
- Restructured data infrastructure from legacy systems to Airflow, Iceberg and FastAPI.
- Client-facing throughout, with CBS, Eurostat and pension funds.

Junior Data Scientist, KR&A

Oct 2021 – Jun 2022

- Flood-occurrence prediction from alternative data (BSc-thesis project); 90%+ accuracy in risk classification.
- Improved API efficiency tenfold through spatial optimisations.

Junior Full-Stack Developer, Exact (former SRXP), part-time

Sep 2019 – Sep 2022

- Enterprise expense-declaration software (EmberJS, PHP) under CI/CD and testing.

RESEARCH

- **Calibrating Free Postcode Boundaries from OpenStreetMap**, preprint (arXiv 2026). Seed-density-to-IoU calibration of an OSM-Voronoi pipeline; NL/DK references, transfer to BE, applied to Italy's 4,209 CAP polygons.
- **When Does Metro Infrastructure Capitalize into Property Prices?**, working paper. Phase-decomposed DiD across seven European cities, $n = 42,004$; wild-cluster-bootstrap inference.
- **A Saturation-Validated Connectivity Score at Parcel Resolution**, method paper in preparation.
- **Building an Agent-Based Model to Explain Gentrification in European Cities** (MSc thesis, 8/8): Amsterdam · Utrecht · Milan.

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science & Business Analytics, Bocconi University · 107/110

2023 – 2025

Focus: Finance · Econometrics · Statistics · NLP

BSc Artificial Intelligence, University of Amsterdam

2019 – 2023

Minor in Linguistics, University of Amsterdam

Erasmus minor, Università di Bologna (UNIBO)

LANGUAGES & SOFT SKILLS

Dutch C2 · English C2 · Italian B2/C1 · German B2 · Spanish A2

Team leadership · Multi-year project management · Client & stakeholder communication · Presenting and defending methodology to technical and senior audiences